

Trump Economic Approval → Policy Pivot Framework

Economic Approval	GOP Approval	Generic Ballot
29%	82%	D+6

Market context: VIX 31 | Gold \$4,495 | WTI \$102 | Brent \$109 | Gas \$3.96

This week: Oil surged past \$100 as Iran formalized Hormuz toll booth; S1 stagflation lock-in probability rising to 30%.

Positioning update: The oil surge past \$100 strengthens S1's stagflation thesis and weakens S3's ceasefire trap. Increase gold and steeper exposure. Gas accelerating ~\$0.24/week per EIA — if it crosses \$4.50 without Congressional action, S2 defection math should accelerate rapidly.

THRESHOLD ALERTS

- CRITICAL: Econ approval (29%) below Biden all-time low (32%)
- CRITICAL: WTI (\$102) crossed \$100 critical threshold
- WARNING: GOP approval (82%) approaching 80% danger zone
- WARNING: VIX (31) in elevated uncertainty zone
- WARNING: Gas price (\$3.96) accelerating toward \$4.00+ (West Coast already \$5.26)

SCENARIO PROBABILITIES

No pivot: 30% (strengthening) — WTI surged past \$100 to \$102; Iran formalizing Hormuz chokehold strengthens the dual supply shock thesis.

Tariff rollback (base case): 45% (stable) — Farm state fertilizer shortage adds pressure but no new Republican defections; generic ballot narrowed to D+6.

Oil trap: 25% (weakening) — Oil surging past \$100 and Iran's Hormuz toll booth contradict the ceasefire-driven oil drop thesis.

Notes: Only 2 days since baseline — polling data largely unchanged (same Reuters/Ipsos 3/20-3/22 period). Key moves: WTI \$94→\$102 (+9%), Brent \$104→\$109 (+4%). Iran formalized Hormuz toll booth regime. Pakistan FM says will 'soon host' US-Iran talks. Yemen Houthis claimed first missile attack on Israel since war started. China opened investigations into US trade practices. USMCA renegotiation starting Monday. Section 122 replacing SCOTUS-struck IEEPA tariffs. Generic ballot narrowed from D+9 to D+6 (RCP avg) — driven by pollster mix, not necessarily real shift. West Coast gas already \$5.26/gal per EIA. 'No Kings' protests drew large crowds in 3,000+ cities (March 29). S&P; 500 in longest losing streak since 2022.

Iran status: War continues. Iran formalizing Hormuz toll booth. Pakistan to host US-Iran talks. Houthis struck Israel. No ceasefire.

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